

BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

Wisdom in Response

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chronicles 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

 **Key Verse:** 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer – When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7 (WEB)

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today. ⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

Solomon has just become king. God appears to him in a dream and basically says, “What do you want Me to give you?” Instead of pretending he has it all together, Solomon admits he feels young and unsure.

Reflection Question

If God asked you, “What do you want Me to give you?” What would your honest first answer be?

Main Course

Bite 1 – What’s Really in Your Heart, 1 Kings 3:8–9 (WEB)

⁸ Your servant is among your people which you have chosen, a great people, that can’t be counted nor numbered for multitude. ⁹ Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours?

Instead of asking for more money, more power, or revenge on his enemies, Solomon asks for an **understanding heart** so he can lead God’s people well. What he asks for shows what matters most to him.

Reflection Question

What do your prayers say about what you care about most?

Bite 2 – God’s Response, 1 Kings 3:10–12 (WEB)

¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹ God said to him, “Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have asked riches for yourself, nor have asked the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice, ¹² behold, I have done according to your word. Behold, I have given you a wise and understanding heart, so that there has been no one like you before you, and after you none will arise like you.

God is **pleased** with Solomon’s request. He gives Solomon the wisdom he asked for, and later adds riches and honor too. God loves when we want what He wants—especially when we ask for wisdom to serve others.

Reflection Question

Where in your life do you most need God’s wisdom right now—school, friendships, money, family, decisions?

Bite 3 – Learning to Seek Wisdom, Proverbs 2:1–6 (WEB)

¹ My son, if you will receive my words, and store up my commandments within you, ² so as to turn your ear to wisdom, and apply your heart to understanding; ³ yes, if you call out for discernment, and lift up your voice for understanding; ⁴ if you seek her as silver, and search for her as for hidden treasures: ⁵ then you will understand the fear of Yahweh, and find the knowledge of God. ⁶ For Yahweh gives wisdom. Out of his mouth comes knowledge and understanding.

Later, Solomon teaches others how to chase wisdom. Wisdom isn't something you sit around and wait for—it's something you **seek like treasure**. Real wisdom comes from God.

Reflection Question

What is one practical way you can start “seeking wisdom like treasure” this week?

Dessert

Solomon's story reminds us:

- What we ask God for shows what's in our heart.
- God loves to give wisdom to people who want to use it His way.

Reflection Question

Finish this quietly: “Lord, help me want _____ more than _____.”

To-Go Box

- God isn't just listening to **what** you ask—He sees **why** you ask.
- Wisdom is worth more than status or stuff.
- When you don't know what to do, asking God for an **understanding heart** is one of the best prayers you can pray.

Write one sentence:

“God, please give me wisdom about _____.”

 **Prayer**

“God, thank You for the way You answered Solomon when he asked for wisdom. Please forgive me for the times I chase stuff more than I chase Your heart. Give me an understanding heart to make good choices, treat people right, and honor You in my decisions. Help me to seek wisdom like treasure. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

 **Personal Prayer Space**

Write your own short prayer asking God for wisdom in a real situation you’re facing:

 **Activity – “Ask Big” (Youth)**

Fill in the blanks from the lesson:

1. God appeared to _____ in a dream and said, “Ask for what you want Me to give you.”
2. Solomon asked for an _____ **heart** to judge God’s people.
3. God was _____ that Solomon asked for wisdom instead of riches or revenge.
4. In Proverbs 2, we are told to seek _____ like silver and hidden treasure.

BM1 – Lesson 3: Jesus

 Prayer as the First Resort

 **Theme:** Talking to God before everything falls apart

 **Background Text:** Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8

 **Key Verse:** **Luke 18:1 (WEB)**

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer – Jesus Pulled Away to Pray, Luke 5:15–16 (WEB)

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. People wanted to hear Jesus and be healed. But instead of just doing more and more, Jesus **chose to pull away and pray**. When things got busier, He didn’t pray less—He prayed **more**.

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first: sleep, fun, prayer, or something else?

Main Course

Bite 1 – “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4 (WEB)

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.
May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.’”

³Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us. Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’ ”

The disciples watched Jesus pray and **wanted that**, not just a script.

Jesus gives them a pattern:

- Start with **who God is** (Father, holy, His Kingdom)
- Ask for **daily needs**
- Ask for **forgiveness** and help to forgive others
- Ask for help in **temptation**

Reflection Question

Which part of that prayer do you use most—praise, daily needs, forgiveness, or help in temptation? Which part do you usually skip?

Bite 2 – Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5 (WEB)

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God, and didn’t respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn’t for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

Jesus tells a story about a judge who doesn’t care about God or people. A widow keeps coming anyway, asking for justice. The judge finally responds—not because he’s good, but because she **doesn’t quit**.

Jesus uses this to show: if even a bad judge listens to persistence, how much more will a **good God** listen to His kids?

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you've stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 – God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8 (WEB)

⁶The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷Won’t God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

Jesus makes the contrast clear:

- God is not like an unjust judge.
- God **hears** His people crying out day and night.
- The question isn’t “Will God answer?” It’s “Will we still have **faith** when He does?”

Reflection Question

What does it look like—for you—to “always pray and not give up” about one thing this week?

Dessert

Jesus’ life says:

- Prayer isn’t just something we do **when all else fails**.
- Prayer is how we **breathe with God**—daily, honestly, persistently.

Reflection Question

Finish this: “From now on, when I feel overwhelmed, I want to **pray first** instead of _____.”

To-Go Box

- If Jesus needed to pull away and pray, we definitely do too.
- Prayer is simple: talk to God, listen, and keep coming back.
- Not every prayer gets answered the way we expect—but **no prayer is ignored**.

Write one sentence:

“Jesus, help me remember to talk to You **before** I _____.”

Prayer

“Jesus, thank You for showing us what real prayer looks like. Forgive me for the times I only pray when I’m desperate. Help me to come to You first—not last. Teach me to pray simply, honestly, and consistently, and not to give up when I don’t see answers right away. In Your name, amen.”

Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth)

Fill in:

1. One thing that stresses me out: _____
2. My usual first response (be honest): _____
3. A new first response I want to try: **Pray before I** _____.

(Answers are personal; no key needed in the student book—only in your heart.)
